



WILLIAM LIANG For The Times

PROTESTING ANTI-LABOR POLICIES

Members of United Teachers Los Angeles cheer during a Labor Day rally in Wilmington. Speakers took turns criticizing moves by the Trump administration that have weakened unions. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

SOME 800 AFGHANS KILLED IN EASTERN TEMBLOR

Late-night 6.0 quake destroys villages in remote, mountainous areas, residents report.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

KABUL — Desperate Afghans clawed through rubble in search of missing loved ones after a strong earthquake killed about 800 people and injured more than 2,500 in eastern Afghanistan, according to figures provided Monday by the Taliban government.

The magnitude 6 quake late Sunday hit towns in the province of Kunar, near the city of Jalalabad in neighboring Nangarhar province, causing extensive damage.

One resident in Nurgal district, one of the worst-affected areas in Kunar, said nearly the entire village was destroyed.

“Children are under the rubble. The elderly are under the rubble. Young people are under the rubble,” said the villager, who did not give his name.

“We need help here,” he pleaded. “We need people to come here and join us. Let us pull out the people who are buried. There is no one who can come and remove dead bodies from under the rubble.”

The quake hit just before midnight and was centered 17 miles east-northeast of Jalalabad, the U.S. Geological Survey said. It was just 5 miles deep. Shallower quakes tend to cause more damage. Several aftershocks followed.

Video showed rescuers taking injured people on stretchers from collapsed buildings and into helicopters as people frantically dug through rubble with their hands.

The Taliban government’s chief spokesman, Zabihullah Mujahid, said at a news conference Monday that the death toll had risen to at least 800 with more than 2,500 injured. He said most of the casualties were in Kunar.

Eastern Afghanistan is mountainous, with remote areas, and the quake has worsened communications. Blocked roads are forcing aid workers to walk four or five hours to reach survivors. Dozens of flights have operated in and out of Nangarhar Airport, taking the injured to hospitals.

Buildings in Afghanistan tend to be low-rise constructions, mostly of concrete and [See Quake, A4]

Two sides in redistricting fight race to sway voters

Millions of dollars in ads are expected before Nov. 4

BY SEEMA MEHTA

Millions of dollars’ worth of political TV ads are expected to start airing Tuesday in an effort to sway Californians on a November ballot measure seeking to send more Democrats to Congress and counter President Trump and the GOP agenda, according to television airtime purchases.

The special-election ballot measure — Proposition 50 — probably will shape control of the U.S. House of Representatives and determine the fate of many of

Trump’s far-right policies.

The opposition to the rare California mid-decade redistricting has booked more than \$10 million of airtime for ads between Tuesday and Sept. 23 in media markets across the state, according to media buyers who are not affiliated with either campaign. Supporters of the effort have bought at least \$2 million in ads starting Tuesday, a number expected to grow exponentially as they are aggressively trying to secure time in coming weeks on broadcast and cable television.

“This early start is a bit

stealthy on the part of the no side but has been used as a ploy in past campaigns to try to show strength early and gain advantage by forcing the opposing side to play catch-up,” said Sheri Sadler, a veteran Democratic political media operative who is not working for either campaign. “This promises to be an expensive campaign for a special election, especially starting so early.”

Millions of dollars have already flowed into the nascent campaigns sparring over the Nov. 4 ballot measure that asks voters to set [See Redistricting, A8]

They’re here to clean up this town — and gather new friends

The retirees gathered at 8 a.m. near the G Line station in Canoga Park, impossible to miss in their neon yellow vests. They clutched trash bags and surveyed the expanse of trash-filled sidewalks and gutters before them.

Group leader Jill Mather, who walks and talks with the efficiency of a military general, laid out the task ahead: Clean a milelong stretch of Sherman Way.

For the next two hours, they plucked Q-tips and chicken bones off the ground with grabber tools. They pulled paper plates and coffee cups from bushes and snatched soiled napkins and vape canisters from the gutters.

Mather scooped a black slipper from an abandoned shopping cart.

“It makes us feel good,” Mather said, lugging a bag. “It’s visibly different. It’s in- [See Cleanup, A8]

Volunteers bond as they collect the trash along L.A.-area streets

BY DAKOTA SMITH



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

DANNY Sinclair, front, and Georgia Altmayer of Volunteers Cleaning Communities fill up trash bags.



SUO TAKEKUMA Pool Photo

TALKS IN TIANJIN

The leaders of Russia, India and China are joining forces to counter U.S. global influence. **WORLD, A3**

Altadena hub is back in business

Country club, a center of community life, reopens months after the January firestorm. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Luxury homes on an old Macy’s lot?

New residents can start moving into apartments this week at the former Westside Pavilion site. **BUSINESS, A10**

Weather

Mostly sunny; hot. L.A. Basin: 93/70. **B6**



Need to rent a mega-mansion for L.A. Games?

Wealthy tourists are already signing leases, with one even paying \$2.4 million up front.

BY JACK FLEMMING

Three years from now, millions of tourists will pour into L.A. for the 2028 Olympics. For most of them, a hotel room or Airbnb will suffice.

Some require a more extravagant stay.

Ten bedrooms. Twenty bathrooms. A private movie theater and infinity pool overlooking the city. A battalion of chefs, butlers and drivers catering to the smallest of whims.

The Earth’s elite — not just the athletes, but the royals, oligarchs and uber-wealthy families coming to watch them — won’t be here for three summers. And the market for mega-mansion rentals is already getting competitive.

“We’re getting five to 10 inquiries per week,” said Hank

Stark, founder of ultra-luxury vacation rental company LuxJB. “There are only so many homes of this size in L.A., and people want to secure their spot as early as possible.”

LuxJB owns 14 mansions around L.A., including in Beverly Hills, the Hollywood Hills and West Hollywood. Three of them have already been secured for the Olympics — not just for the last two weeks of July while the Games are taking place, but for most of the year.

“If you’re an Olympic federation from a specific country, you’ll be here all year training athletes before the Games begin,” Stark said. “If you’re a major sports brand, you’ll want a presence in L.A. before and after July.”

The crown jewel of LuxJB’s collection is a 39,000-square-foot behemoth complete with nine bedrooms, four kitchens, a gym, spa, movie theater, pickleball court, basketball court and a team of three maids. A client just rented it [See Olympics, A7]

Voices **MARK SWED** MUSIC CRITIC

Esa-Pekka Salonen returns to L.A. Phil in innovative role

At his final concert as music director of the Los Angeles Philharmonic 16 years ago, every musician in the orchestra stood in line onstage to hug a red-faced Esa-Pekka Salonen. At every Salonen L.A. Phil appearance as conductor laureate this last year, energized audiences have begun the mantra of “bring him back.”

That wish is now being granted. The L.A. Phil has created a new position of creative director for Salonen beginning in the 2026/27 season. He will conduct the orchestra for four weeks next season and then for a minimum of six weeks the following seasons.

While the five-year appointment makes no administrative demands on Salonen, it will allow him to pursue special projects, create festivals, commission premieres, mentor young conductors in a Salonen International Conducting Fellowship and collaborate with Lightroom, the imaginative British high-tech and artist-



DAVID SWANSON For The Times

THE CONDUCTOR will be “creative director.”

led immersive art venture.

This may not answer the question of who will follow Gustavo Dudamel. The search remains ongoing as Dudamel is about to begin his final season as L.A. Phil music director before taking over the New York Philharmonic. But this does assure the continuation of Salonen’s progressive vision for an orchestra of the 21st century that transformed the L.A. Phil into the world’s most successful and influential symphony orchestra.

[See L.A. Phil, A14]

Chagas disease takes hold in U.S., California

Deadly illness may be sickening far more people than is known.

BY SUSANNE RUST

It’s one of the most insidious diseases you’ve never heard of, but Chagas is here in California and 29 other states across the U.S.

It kills more people in Latin America than malaria each year, and researchers think roughly 300,000 people in the U.S. currently have it but are unaware.

That’s because the illness tends to lie dormant for years, making itself known only when its victim keels over via heart attack, stroke or death.

Chagas disease is caused by the parasite *Trypanosoma cruzi*, which lives in a bloodsucking insect called the kissing bug. There are roughly a dozen species of kissing bugs in the U.S. and

four in California known to carry the parasite. Research has shown that in some places, such as Los Angeles’ Griffith Park, about a third of all kissing bugs harbor the Chagas disease parasite.

It’s why a team of epidemiologists, researchers and medical doctors are calling on the World Health Organization and the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention to label the disease as endemic, meaning consistently present, in the U.S. They hope that will bring awareness, education, dialogue and potentially public health investment to a disease that has long carried a stigma, falsely associated with poor, rural migrants from bug-infected homes in far-off tropical nations.

“This is a disease that has been neglected and has been impacting Latin Americans for many decades,” said Norman Beatty, a medical epidemiologist at the University of Florida and an ex- [See Chagas, A7]